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Lead Architect (Ref: 18558)

Ministry of Justice

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 21st June 2026

Ministry of
JUSTICE

Reference number

465531

Salary

£71,381 - £85,257

The national salary is £71,381 - £80,419. London salary is £75,674 - £85,257. Your salary will be dependent on your base location.
London: £75,674-£87,875 (which may include an allowance of up to £12,201) National: £71,381- £83,700 (which may include an allowance of up to £12,319)

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 6
MOJ Grade 6

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Part-time

Number of jobs available

2

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Location

East Midlands (England), East of England, London (region), North East England, North West England, Scotland, South East England, South West England, Wales, West Midlands (England), Yorkshire and the Humber

About the job

Job summary

This is a Nationally based role

Job description

Lead Architect

Location: National*

Closing Date: ~~Closing Date:~~ 21st June

Interviews: from 25th June

Grade: G6

Salary: London: £75,674-£87,875 (which may include an allowance of up to £12,201) National: £71,381- £83,700 (which may include an allowance of up to £12,319)

Working pattern: Full-time/Part-time/Flexible working

Contract Type: Permanent

Vacancy number:

Number of vacancies: 3

***We offer a hybrid working model, allowing for a balance between remote work and time spent in your local office. Office locations can be found [ON THIS MAP](#)**

Please note that unless you are an existing member of staff at Justice Digital, Data and Science, the only London location being recruited to is 10 South Colonnade, E14 4PU. We are no longer recruiting to 102 Petty France, SW1H 9AJ.

The Role

We're recruiting for **Lead Architects** here at [Justice Digital](#), to be part of our warm and collaborative teams within the [Legal Aid Agency](#). Our lead architects are responsible for assuring, designing, and delivering digital services that make a genuine difference to people's lives. A Lead Architect will work alongside a service owner, overseeing the work of up to 10 engineering teams. Together we will collaborate to develop our strategy, connect people and build trust with clear communication, and provide empathetic technical leadership across diverse teams.

This role aligns against the [Lead Technical Architect Role](#) from the Government Digital and Data Framework.

Our Lead Architects will work to understand our technology, our business, and our people (colleagues, stakeholders, and users of our services), and to create an ambitious and pragmatic vision for our teams, using their technical expertise to bring our challenges and opportunities into focus alongside the views of other professions in our leadership team.

In LAA Digital believe that architecture is not purely a technical discipline. The systems we build are shaped by the teams that build them, the organisational structures they sit within, and the communication patterns between the people involved. Our architects think about how team structures, domain boundaries, and organisational dynamics shape systems – and how the systems we design, in turn, shape the organisation. We are looking for people who understand that designing great systems means co-designing the social

and technical dimensions together, and who bring both technical depth and organisational awareness to their work.

This role requires clear communication and structured thinking skills. A Lead Architect can see the big picture, understanding our complex technology landscape, and can clearly and effectively communicate with both specialist and non-specialist audiences.

By building trust, developing great relationships, and empathising with others you will support the development of the architecture community and engineering leadership within your service area, providing guidance, mentorship, and technical leadership across teams.

A Lead Architect will have a good understanding of a broad range of technologies, with hands on experience in both software engineering and commercial enterprise, as well as providing effective governance, both within our organisation, and across our suppliers.

You will receive a range of excellent benefits when you join our department, including:

A generous employer pension contribution of 28.97% through the Civil Service Pension Scheme.

25 days of annual leave, (increasing to 30 days once you have reached 5 years of service), plus 8 bank holidays and a privilege day for the King's birthday.

Flexible working arrangements including hybrid working, working part time or compressed hours. Designed to support a positive work life balance.

Employees are allocated **10% of their working time for personal and professional development.**

A £1k per person learning budget is in place to support all our people, with access to best-in-class conferences and seminars, accreditation with professional bodies, fully funded vocational programmes and e-learning platforms.

Compassionate maternity, adoption, and shared parental leave policies, with up to 26 weeks leave at full pay, 13 weeks with partial pay, and 13 weeks further leave. And maternity support/paternity leave at full pay for 2 weeks, too!

You can find more details of the Benefits we offer [here](#). To help picture your life at [MoJ Justice Digital, Data and Science](#) please take a look at our [blog](#).

Key Responsibilities

Create a technical vision for Legal Aid, develop our strategy, and be accountable for our technology estate as part of our Architect Leadership Team.

Communicate about our technology across teams and professions, not just within our Digital unit but across all parts of the Ministry of Justice and with our suppliers and partners; seeing the big picture and bringing it to all stakeholders.

Collaborate and find agreement with senior stakeholders, providing both technical and non-technical direction and challenge, as well as pragmatic compromise to deliver value.

Maintain a holistic view of the end-to-end service ecosystem within Legal Aid, identifying technical dependencies and risks, actively seeking opportunities for improvement and collaboration, and ensuring we as a profession are actively producing, maintaining, and owning the associated enterprise architecture documentation.

Empower teams to make pragmatic and incremental change, through influence and inspiration, setting both a vision for the future and an empathetic path that people and teams will be able to follow.

Guide and influence choices to align with strategy, and seek out opportunities for digital transformation, helping all understand the value of technical decisions.

Engage with our portfolio, assurance, risk management, cyber, and information assurance leadership to ensure their priorities are represented alongside those of the business and other digital teams.

Mentor, coach, line-manage, and recruit more great architects and engineering leadership, helping build a sustainable work force plan to deliver our strategy.

Champion inclusive working practices and support efforts to grow diversity, inclusivity and balance across engineering roles.

Run community-of-practice initiatives within the architecture and engineering functions.

Promote open dialogue, collaborative problem solving, and continuous learning within our technical community.

Our Tech Stack

This is our tech, both strategic and legacy. You don't need to have experience with all of these, but we hope you see some familiar things.

Modern languages and frameworks built in Ruby, Java, and Python

Resilient infrastructure in the cloud (primarily AWS), using infrastructure as code (IaC) and platforms as a service (PaaS)

Progressive software development practices such as Domain-Driven Design (DDD), test-driven development (TDD), continuous integration (CI) and continuous delivery (CD)

A new multi-tier architecture, creating central data and business logic platforms to accelerate our product development.

Enterprise Oracle software, including Enterprise Resource Planning (E-Business Suite)

Mac or Windows-based development environments and public [GitHub repositories](#)

if you're interested in finding out more about the work our architects do in LAA Digital, please join us on 10th June at 12:00. In the session, we will explain a little more about the recruitment process and what it is like to work within the Civil Service. More importantly, you'll hear first-hand from our lead architects about the work they do. Please come along with your questions and learn more about the team and the role.

For more information and to register, visit [\[link\]](#)

If this feels like an exciting challenge, something you are enthusiastic about, and want to join our team please read on and apply!

Person Specification

Essential

A systems thinking mindset and the ability to see the big picture - how changes in one part of a sociotechnical system (people, process, technology, governance) affect others, to reason about emergent

behaviours in complex environments, and to make trade-offs accordingly leading to iterative, outcome-focused, and effective change towards a strategic vision. Comfort with ambiguity and complexity is essential.

Demonstrated leadership experience in a technical, solution, or infrastructure architecture role, with a background in either software engineering or enterprise architecture, acting as a recognised expert to guide, critique, and support teams.

Excellent communication skills, with the ability to distil complex and nuanced information into clear, concise messaging at all levels, from specialist developers through to non-technical executive leadership, developing mutual understanding and trust to drive consensus and reach decisions.

Experience assuring services in a complex technical estate through effective risk management and technical governance, both within your own teams and across commercial engagements with third parties.

Practical knowledge of modern application architectures (e.g., microservices, APIs, web frameworks, data persistence technologies or event driven architecture in public cloud environments)

Experience in introducing and championing best practices such as agile development, domain-driven design (DDD), test-driven development (TDD), continuous integration (CI), continuous delivery (CD), and DevOps, fostering high-quality engineering culture within teams.

Willingness to be assessed against the requirements for SC clearance

We welcome the unique contribution diverse applicants bring and do not discriminate based on culture, ethnicity, race, nationality or national origin, age, sex, gender identity or expression, religion or belief, disability status, sexual orientation, educational or social background or any other factor.

Our values are Purpose, Humanity Openness and Together. Find out more here about how we celebrate diversity and an inclusive culture in our workplace.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

Salary Information**

Base salary for this role is from: London: £75,674-£87,875 National: £71,381-£83,700

New entrants to the Civil Service joining the MoJ are expected to start at the minimum of the pay band.

Existing Civil Servants moving on a level transfer will retain their current base salary or move to the minimum of the pay band for the role, whichever is higher.

Existing Civil Servants who are promoted will either move to the bottom of the new grade's pay band or receive a 10% uplift, whichever provides the greater increase.

Candidates may also be eligible for a non-pensionable Government Digital & Data Allowance of up to £12,201 per year (London) or £12,319 (National). This is a temporary allowance, reviewed annually and may be retained, amended, or withdrawn.

The final offer will reflect the skills and experience you demonstrate during the assessment process.

How to Apply

In Justice Digital, Data and Science, we recruit using a combination of the Government Digital and Data Profession Capability and Success Profiles Frameworks. We shall assess a combination of your Experience, Technical skills and Behaviours during the assessment process.

Stage 1 - Application and sift:

To apply for this position, you must submit the following as part of your application:

A **CV** detailing your career history (including any relevant qualifications). Your CV will be assessed against the essential criteria outlined within the Person Specification of this advert.

A **Personal Statement** (no more than 750 words) which should outline your experience and skills, giving clear examples of work

undertaken. It should specifically address the following 3 criteria listed below, using a separate paragraph for each.

Demonstrated leadership experience in a technical, solution, or infrastructure architecture role, with a background in either software engineering or enterprise architecture, acting as a recognised expert to guide, critique, and support teams.

Practical knowledge of modern application architectures (e.g., microservices, APIs, web frameworks, data persistence technologies or event driven architecture in public cloud environments)

Experience in introducing and championing best practices such as agile development, domain-driven design (DDD), test-driven development (TDD), continuous integration (CI), continuous delivery (CD), and DevOps, fostering high-quality engineering culture within teams.

A diverse sift panel will review the information in your CV and Personal Statement to assess the sift criteria specified above. We operate an anonymous shortlisting process. Please ensure your CV and Personal Statement do not include your name or any other identifying details.

Should we receive a high volume of applications, a pre-sift based on the following will be conducted before the sift.

Demonstrated leadership experience in a technical, solution, or infrastructure architecture role, with a background in either software engineering or enterprise architecture, acting as a recognised expert to guide, critique, and support teams.

Practical knowledge of modern application architectures (e.g., microservices, APIs, web frameworks, data persistence technologies or event driven architecture in public cloud environments)

Please access the following link for guidance on how to apply - [Application Guidance](#)

Stage 2 - Interviews:

Successful candidates who meet the required standard will then be invited to a panel interview held via Microsoft Teams. At interview stage, you will be

assessed against the following Success Profile elements - Experience, Technical and the following Behaviours:

Leadership

Communicating and Influencing

Seeing the Big Picture

Making Effective Decisions

As part of your interview, you will be asked to deliver a presentation that assesses your technical capability / experience. Further details will be provided if successful at sift.

Appointments are made strictly in merit order. In the event that two or more candidates receive identical interview scores, the practical knowledge of modern application architectures (e.g., microservices, APIs, web frameworks, data persistence technologies or event driven architecture in public cloud environments) will be applied as the primary lead criterion to determine the final merit order.

Should you be unsuccessful in the role that you have applied for but demonstrate the capability for a role at a lower level, we reserve the right to discuss this opportunity with you and offer you the position without needing a further application.

A reserve list may be held for up to 12 months, from which further appointments may be made.

Use of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Terms & Conditions

Please review our Terms and Conditions which set out how we recruit and provide further information related to the role and salary arrangements.

If you have any questions, please feel free to contact digitalanddatarecruitment@justice.gov.uk

Person specification

Please refer to the attached Job Description

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £71,381, Ministry of Justice contributes £20,679 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides.

Access to learning and development

A working environment that supports a range of flexible working options to enhance your work life balance

A working culture which encourages inclusion and diversity

A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Annual Leave

Public Holidays

Season Ticket Advance

For more information about the recruitment process, benefits and allowances and answers to general queries, please click the below link which will direct you to our Candidate Information Page.

Link: <https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ>

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

To apply for this position, you must submit the following as part of your application:

A **CV** detailing your career history (including any relevant qualifications). Your CV will be assessed against the essential criteria outlined within the Person Specification of this advert.

A **Personal Statement** (no more than 750 words) which should outline your experience and skills, giving clear examples of work undertaken. It should specifically address the following 3 criteria listed below, using a separate paragraph for each.

Demonstrated leadership experience in a technical, solution, or infrastructure architecture role, with a background in either software engineering or enterprise architecture, acting as a recognised expert to guide, critique, and support teams.

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Practical knowledge of modern application architectures (e.g., microservices, APIs, web frameworks, data persistence technologies or event driven architecture in public cloud environments)

Please access the following link for guidance on how to apply - [Application Guidance](#)

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a](#)

[new window](#)) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	SSCL Recruitment Enquiries Team
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk
Telephone :	0345 241 5359
Recruitment team	
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel a department has breached the requirement of the Recruitment Principles and would like to raise this, please contact SSCL (Moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@gov.sscl.com) in the first instance. If the role has been advertised externally (outside of the Civil Service) and you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their web pages: <http://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/civil-service-recruitment/complaints/>

<https://www.jobtrain.co.uk/justicedigital/Job/JobDetail?JobId=1070>

Civil Service
Commission

